

Listening into Writing



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Assessment



- At the end of the course, you will have a 'Listening into Writing' assessment (Paper A).
- This will involve listening to a live lecture (20-25 minutes), taking notes and then writing a critical summary of the lecture using your notes (40 minutes).
- Your summary should be 200-400 words long.

This assessment (Paper A: Listening into Writing) will contribute to your marks for:

- a) Listening (60 out of 90 marks – the other 30 come from Paper C: Interviews)
- b) Writing (10 out of 90 marks – the other 80 marks come from:
 - Paper B: Reading into Writing (40 marks)
 - The Assignment (40 marks)

Marking criteria for listening



For the highest listening marks:

- All statements will report the lecture content accurately.
- Paraphrasing will be highly successful; no more than four words in a row will be copied directly from the lecture.
- The summary will be an appropriate length.
- The summary will cover all the key points.
- The summary will be 'highly appropriate' in terms of detail and depth.

Marking criteria for writing



For the highest writing marks:

- The writer will use a good range of sophisticated grammar and vocabulary.
- There will be virtually no errors in the use of grammar and vocabulary.
- The style will be appropriate.
- Critical comments will be well-supported and integrated with the summary, without overgeneralising or introducing unsupported personal opinion.
- Ideas will be structured in an extremely clear and coherent manner using an excellent range of cohesive devices.

Marking criteria



You can see the full marking criteria on Moodle



- Each week, you will have practice with a recorded podcast/lecture.
- In Week 5, you will have practice with a live lecture.
- Summarising the live lecture will be easier than summarising the recorded podcasts/lectures so don't worry if you find this task difficult initially.

Note-taking from speech



- Taking notes from speech (in a lecture, tutorial or from recorded audio) can be difficult because it may not be possible to ask the speaker to repeat their words.
- Become accustomed to listening intently. The speaker may signpost significant moments by saying things such as: "I will discuss three main ways in which ...", or "I would like to move on to another topic...".

Note-taking from speech



- Be wary of noting down as fact what a speaker might mention as an example of a contentious view.
- Become used to thinking actively about what you are listening to. You probably don't need to take notes on everything so get used to identifying what does need to be noted down and what you can let go.

Note-taking from speech



- Create a wide margin down one side of the notepaper you use to take notes. Later on, when you look at your notes again, use the margin area to summarise or add extra notes.
- You might like the Cornell note-taking method. Watch this clip to find out more: <https://lsc.cornell.edu/how-to-study/taking-notes/cornell-note-taking-system/>

Cornell Notetaking Method

Cue Column

Notes Column

2.5 Inches

6 Inches

- Main Ideas
- Questions that connect points
- Diagrams
- Study prompts

When?

After class
During review

- Main lecture notes here
- Use concise sentences
- Use shorthand symbols
- Use abbreviations
- Use lists
- Put space between points

When?

During class

Summary Column

- For top level, main ideas
- Use as a quick reference area

When?

After class
During review

2"

- Your summary should have a clear structure. You will need to decide whether to use a linear summary or a thematic summary.
- A linear summary follows the structure of the original lecture. This can be effective if the lecture is clearly and logically structured.
- A thematic structure extracts ideas from the lecture and reorganises them.

Whether you use a linear or thematic structure, you should reflect on the content of the lecture:

- Who is making the arguments? Are they a credible source (why/why not)? Are they likely to be biased?
- What are the central arguments in the lecture?
- What evidence is used to support those arguments?
- Is the evidence persuasive?
- Is the link (“warrant”) between the arguments and the evidence convincing?
- Do the arguments need to be qualified e.g., are they always valid or only relevant to a particular time or place?
- Are there alternative arguments (rebuttals)?
- What are the implications of the argument(s)?

When summarising a lecture, you should make it clear:

- a) When you are reporting what the speaker says;
- b) When you are evaluating what the speaker says.



Use reporting views and expressions e.g.

- *In the lecture, X states...*
- *He/She argues...*
- *According to X...*

Use evaluative language e.g.

- X's argument is convincing/persuasive because...
- X's argument is supported by...
- X's argument is flawed/questionable because...
- X's argument is contradicted by...
- X's argument is important because...
- X's argument is not relevant because...

Cohesion



Use cohesive language e.g.

- and, also, furthermore, moreover...
- but, however, although, in contrast...
- so, therefore, thus, as a result, hence...
- first, second, next, then, after...
- for example, for instance, to illustrate, namely...
- in particular, especially, particularly, above all
- turning to, with regard to, with reference to, as far as x is concerned...